Pros	A large degree of autonomy for data-producing teams. Runs as a service. Extremely low maintenance effort. Wide support for both data analytics workloads. Wide support for development teams.
Cons	Lock-in effect into cloud provider–specific services (but much less than in the previous setup). Requires a team to run the platform.
Suitable situations	Medium- to large-sized companies prioritizing maximum flexibility for data-producing teams.

As promised, we're now going to explore a more centralized approach with a larger central platform in the middle.

8.3 Data mesh on Databricks

This section's architecture is inspired by real-world implementations by DPG Media, Zalando, and many more. Unlike the AWS and GCP versions of the data meshes, a data mesh on Databricks looks a lot like a centralized data setup—at least with respect to technology.

That brings obvious benefits: namely, ease of setup and typical centralization benefits. This approach also has two big but not-so-obvious drawbacks:

- By centralizing large parts of the infrastructure, we're again subjecting ourselves to central bottlenecks. The effect of this is much smaller when using a hosted shared service, but it is still there. Additionally, we are physically centralizing the data in one place.
- By centralizing parts of the process, we're making the data domain ownership a lot harder to understand. In such a technical architecture, it is of prime importance to put the focus on the processes, the people, and the organization.